

# Semester University Launch Readiness, HECVAT, Data Migration, and Pilot Contract Playbook

**Prepared:** September 29, 2026

**Purpose:** Practical launch-readiness audit, HECVAT preparation checklist, WCAG 2.2 go-live controls, data-migration approach, service-level packaging, university pricing guidance, and first-pilot contract outline for Semester.

**Important:** This document is an operational planning template, not legal advice, a HECVAT completion, a WCAG conformance claim, a FERPA determination, or a contractual instrument. Use qualified counsel, institutional privacy officers, security professionals, accessibility specialists, and procurement leadership to finalize all policies, agreements, assessments, and representations.

## 1. Go-live decision standard

A Semester university launch is approved only when all of the following are true:

- The defined student cohort can complete the core workflow end to end.
- The institution approves the defined data scope and authorized purpose.
- Access, consent, tenant isolation, and audit controls are tested.
- Student-facing data shows source, freshness, and limitation.
- The product works with keyboard navigation, screen readers, mobile reflow, and error monitoring, support, incident response, backups, and rollback are operational.
- The institution has training, communication, and escalation contacts.
- The pilot has success measures, a review date, and a documented expansion/exit decision.

## 2. HECVAT preparation checklist

EDUCAUSE describes the Higher Education Community Vendor Assessment Toolkit (HECVAT) as a higher-education vendor-risk assessment tool. It covers areas including cybersecurity, data privacy, IT accessibility, and compliance. Institutions may request HECVAT Lite, Full, or tailored materials depending on their risk process.

### 2.1 Company and governance

| Control                                       | Evidence to prepare                     | Status | Owner |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|--------|-------|
| Legal entity and company ownership documented | Entity documents; company profile       |        |       |
| Security leadership assigned                  | Security charter; named owner           |        |       |
| Privacy leadership assigned                   | Privacy governance charter; named owner |        |       |

| Control                                                             | Evidence to prepare                        | Status | Owner |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|--------|-------|
| Risk-management process defined                                     | Risk register; review cadence              |        |       |
| Vendor-management process defined                                   | Vendor inventory; assessment template      |        |       |
| Security policy set maintained                                      | Policy index with revision dates           |        |       |
| Employee/contractor confidentiality and IP terms exist              | Agreement templates; signed-record process |        |       |
| Background checks or personnel controls documented where applicable | HR/security policy                         |        |       |
| Security training process exists                                    | Training record and annual plan            |        |       |
| Incident response team and contacts defined                         | Incident plan; contact tree                |        |       |

## 2.2 Data privacy and FERPA posture

| Control                                                                           | Evidence to prepare                                 | Status | Owner |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|--------|-------|
| Data inventory is complete                                                        | Field-level data inventory                          |        |       |
| Data classification is defined                                                    | Public/Internal/Student Private/Restricted standard |        |       |
| Data-flow map is complete                                                         | Architecture and data-flow diagram                  |        |       |
| Authorized purpose is documented per institutional deployment                     | DPA; pilot SOW; configuration record                |        |       |
| Minimum-necessary data rule is implemented                                        | Connector scope and field-mapping registry          |        |       |
| No sale of student data policy is published                                       | Student Data Promise; Privacy Policy                |        |       |
| No education-record behavioral advertising policy exists                          | Advertising/Sponsorship Policy                      |        |       |
| Subprocessor register is current                                                  | Public subprocessor list                            |        |       |
| Retention schedule exists                                                         | Retention matrix; deletion jobs                     |        |       |
| Export and deletion workflow exists                                               | Product evidence; support runbook; tests            |        |       |
| Consent/sharing controls are explicit and revocable                               | Consent model; UX; audit logs                       |        |       |
| Institutional education-record data is not redisclosed outside authorized purpose | DPA; vendor controls; access policy                 |        |       |
| Privacy request workflow exists                                                   | Data request runbook and ticket queue               |        |       |
| Incident notification obligations are documented                                  | Contract clause; IR plan                            |        |       |

## 2.3 Identity, access, and authentication

| Control                                          | Evidence to prepare                  | Status | Owner |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------|-------|
| SSO supported where institution requires it      | SAML/OIDC implementation guide       |        |       |
| Administrator MFA enforced                       | Policy and implementation evidence   |        |       |
| High-risk actions require fresh authentication   | Auth architecture and test evidence  |        |       |
| RBAC/ABAC policy model documented                | Permission matrix; capability design |        |       |
| Object-level access controls tested              | API/RLS test evidence                |        |       |
| Tenant isolation tested                          | Automated tenant-isolation tests     |        |       |
| Access reviews are scheduled                     | Access-review procedure              |        |       |
| Offboarding/deprovisioning supported             | SCIM/manual deprovisioning process   |        |       |
| Session timeout and recovery behavior documented | Authentication policy                |        |       |

## 2.4 Application and database security

| Control                                                 | Evidence to prepare                       | Status | Owner |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--------|-------|
| Secure SDLC exists                                      | SDLC policy; PR checklist                 |        |       |
| Code review required                                    | Branch protection/PR process              |        |       |
| Dependency scanning runs in CI                          | CI logs; vulnerability procedure          |        |       |
| Secret scanning runs in CI                              | CI logs; remediation procedure            |        |       |
| SAST/DAST approach is documented                        | Security test plan                        |        |       |
| Threat modeling occurs for high-risk features           | Threat-model templates and records        |        |       |
| RLS and database grants are reviewed                    | RLS inventory; linter resolution register |        |       |
| SECURITY DEFINER functions are inventoried and approved | RPC security-definer register             |        |       |
| API input validation and rate limits exist              | API specifications; tests                 |        |       |
| Audit logs capture sensitive activity                   | Audit schema; sample reports              |        |       |
| Security headers and transport encryption configured    | Deployment configuration evidence         |        |       |
| Vulnerability remediation SLAs exist                    | Severity matrix; risk register            |        |       |

## 2.5 Infrastructure, resilience, and operations

| Control                                                        | Evidence to prepare              | Status | Owner |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------|-------|
| Production, staging, preview, and local environments separated | Environment inventory            |        |       |
| Secrets are managed server-side                                | Secrets-management procedure     |        |       |
| Backups are configured                                         | Backup policy; provider evidence |        |       |

| Control                                              | Evidence to prepare                    | Status | Owner |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|--------|-------|
| Restore testing has occurred                         | Restore-drill record                   |        |       |
| RTO/RPO objectives are defined                       | Business-continuity plan               |        |       |
| Monitoring and alerting are active                   | Dashboard screenshots; runbooks        |        |       |
| Runtime-error tracking is active                     | Error dashboard; triage process        |        |       |
| Integration health monitoring exists                 | Sync dashboard; stale-data policy      |        |       |
| Incident-response runbooks exist                     | Incident plan; tabletop record         |        |       |
| Status page and customer communication process exist | Status page; communication templates   |        |       |
| Rollback process is tested                           | Rollback playbook; deployment evidence |        |       |
| Capacity and peak-period plan exists                 | Registration/load test plan            |        |       |

## 2.6 AI governance

| Control                                                    | Evidence to prepare                     | Status | Owner |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|--------|-------|
| AI use is publicly disclosed                               | AI Policy; in-product labels            |        |       |
| Approved AI providers/models are inventoried               | Provider registry                       |        |       |
| Provider data-use terms reviewed                           | Vendor assessment evidence              |        |       |
| No unauthorized model training on student/institution data | Contract/configuration evidence         |        |       |
| Source permissions checked before retrieval                | Architecture and test evidence          |        |       |
| Source citations/limitations are shown where applicable    | Product screenshots; evaluation reports |        |       |
| Course/institution AI policy hierarchy exists              | Policy console evidence                 |        |       |
| Prompt-injection defense tests exist                       | Adversarial test suite                  |        |       |
| High-impact actions require exact preview and confirmation | UI/API tests and audit evidence         |        |       |
| AI history and output deletion are supported               | Product controls; retention policy      |        |       |
| AI quality, cost, latency, and safety monitoring exist     | AI evaluation dashboard                 |        |       |
| AI incident and feedback process exists                    | Support/IR playbook                     |        |       |

## 2.7 Accessibility and WCAG 2.2

| Control                           | Evidence to prepare               | Status | Owner |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|--------|-------|
| Accessibility statement published | Public page and reporting contact |        |       |
| WCAG 2.2 AA baseline adopted      | Engineering quality standard      |        |       |
| VPAT or dated VPAT roadmap exists | VPAT document/roadmap             |        |       |
| Keyboard navigation tested        | Manual test records               |        |       |

| Control                                                  | Evidence to prepare          | Status | Owner |
|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|--------|-------|
| Visible focus and focus order tested                     | QA records                   |        |       |
| Screen-reader paths tested                               | NVDA/VoiceOver test records  |        |       |
| Contrast and non-color indicators tested                 | Design-token evidence        |        |       |
| Zoom/reflow tested                                       | 200–400% zoom QA results     |        |       |
| Reduced-motion support tested                            | UI settings and QA evidence  |        |       |
| Captions/transcripts process exists                      | Content publishing checklist |        |       |
| Tables, charts, documents, and exports accessible        | Component/export test suite  |        |       |
| Accessibility issues have a support and remediation path | Ticket workflow and SLA      |        |       |

### 3. Registration-module go-live checklist

#### Product and student experience

- [ ] Student can create/sign in to an account securely.
- [ ] Student can choose a program/academic context or enter planning data.
- [ ] Path Snapshot clearly labels verified, imported, student-entered, estimated, and
- [ ] Student can search and compare approved course options.
- [ ] Student can create a term plan.
- [ ] Schedule conflict detection works and explains conflicts.
- [ ] Student can add a primary course option and ranked backups.
- [ ] Registration readiness checklist is available.
- [ ] Student can create an advisor agenda.
- [ ] Student can save/export/share an agenda only with explicit confirmation.
- [ ] Registration time and hold category display only when source is current and approved
- [ ] Student sees official registration handoff and source/freshness state.
- [ ] Semester never promises a seat or official eligibility without verified source data
- [ ] Student can report wrong data or request help.

#### Registrar and governance

- [ ] Catalog and requirement data have named institutional owners.
- [ ] Course and section content has source URL/system and last-reviewed date.
- [ ] Registration rules have documented source and effective date.
- [ ] Course prerequisites, restrictions, and capacity data are source-labeled.
- [ ] Source refresh target and stale-data behavior are configured.
- [ ] Registrar role can publish or approve registration windows through controlled workflow
- [ ] No client user can alter official registration, enrollment, or hold state without approval
- [ ] Audit records capture administrative changes.
- [ ] Institution approves pilot scope and data fields.

## Technical and resilience

- [ ] Course search performance is tested under expected peak load.
- [ ] Plan-save behavior is durable and idempotent.
- [ ] Conflict calculations have unit and end-to-end tests.
- [ ] Stale SIS/catalog data is visibly marked.
- [ ] Integration failure has official fallback behavior.
- [ ] Repeated/out-of-order events do not create duplicate actions or plans.
- [ ] Feature flag exists for Registration Day Mode and can be disabled per tenant.
- [ ] Monitoring exists for plan save, course search, sync freshness, and official-hand
- [ ] Registration-related notifications honor quiet hours and user preferences.

## 4. LMS and Course Studio go-live checklist

### Learning experience

- [ ] Course context is accurate, source-labeled, and tenant-scoped.
- [ ] Student can access approved course materials according to permissions.
- [ ] Upload/connect pipeline validates file type and scans untrusted files.
- [ ] Extraction preserves page, slide, timestamp, and file-version anchors.
- [ ] Student reviews extracted syllabus dates before they create actions/calendar entri
- [ ] Study assets show source citations and allow correction/deletion.
- [ ] Course AI policy is visible and enforced.
- [ ] Active-assessment restrictions provide safe alternatives, not dead ends.
- [ ] Student can create study plans and use practice tools.
- [ ] Student workspace files/drafts are private by default.
- [ ] Any sharing is explicit, scoped, expiring where appropriate, and auditable.

### Faculty experience

- [ ] Faculty can create/approve course source packs where enabled.
- [ ] Faculty can publish course AI policy and allowed-use guidance.
- [ ] Faculty can review how students see course materials and support resources.
- [ ] Faculty role does not automatically reveal private student plans, personal notes
- [ ] Assessment/gradebook features are clearly labeled as practice, draft, or official
- [ ] Any official-grade sync requires institution approval, audit, and reconciliation

### Integration and standards

- [ ] LTI 1.3/LTI Advantage configuration is documented and tested if enabled.
- [ ] LTI launches validate issuer, audience, deployment, nonce, state, and signature.
- [ ] Deep links return students to authorized LMS destinations.
- [ ] Names/roles access is restricted to current course context and authorized use.
- [ ] Assignment/grade exchange is disabled until institutionally approved and tested.
- [ ] LMS connection status, granted scopes, last sync, and disconnect controls are vis
- [ ] No unsupported claim is made that Semester replaces official LMS grading before c

## 5. Student-data migration playbook

### 5.1 Migration principle

Migrate only data needed for the approved Semester scope. Do not import all historical student data simply because it is available.

```
Discover
→ classify
→ minimize
→ map
→ transform
→ sample import
→ validate
→ reconcile
→ parallel run
→ cutover
→ archive/export legacy data
→ monitor and correct
```

### 5.2 Migration inventory

| Data domain          | Pilot default                        | Expansion option                                         | High-risk considerations                               |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Identity             | SSO identifier / local account       | SCIM lifecycle                                           | Avoid duplicate accounts; protect identifiers          |
| Student profile      | Student-entered minimum context      | Approved program/term data                               | Do not import sensitive demographic data unnecessarily |
| Program/requirements | Curated or approved planning data    | SIS/catalog feed                                         | Clearly label estimates until verified                 |
| Course catalog       | Curated course list                  | Full catalog/section sync                                | Source freshness and effective dates                   |
| Enrollment           | Manual or approved current-term list | SIS roster sync                                          | Minimum field access and tenant scope                  |
| Plans                | Student-created                      | Legacy plan import                                       | Preserve owner and edit history                        |
| Course materials     | Student-selected/authorized files    | Approved LMS content                                     | Copyright, access, deletion, academic integrity        |
| Grades               | Exclude initially                    | Approved read-only summary or formal gradebook migration | High sensitivity; official-record controls             |
| Financial data       | Exclude initially                    | High-level deadlines/holds; later authorized workflows   | PCI, aid and account confidentiality                   |
| Housing/health       | Exclude initially                    | Narrow service workflows                                 | Restricted data and special legal obligations          |

| Data domain   | Pilot default     | Expansion option                                    | High-risk considerations            |
|---------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Support cases | Exclude initially | Migration only with explicit purpose/retention plan | Sensitive notes and confidentiality |

### 5.3 Required migration artifacts

Migration charter  
 Source-system inventory  
 Approved data scope  
 Data Processing Addendum / institutional agreement  
 Data classification map  
 Field mapping specification  
 Transformation rules  
 Data quality rules  
 Duplicate and identity resolution rules  
 Sample data set and expected results  
 Migration runbook  
 Rollback plan  
 Reconciliation report  
 Exception register  
 Cutover approval record  
 Archive/export plan  
 Post-migration validation report

### 5.4 Field-mapping template

| Source field        | Semester field          | Classification  | Transformation               | Owner             | Retention            | Validation            |
|---------------------|-------------------------|-----------------|------------------------------|-------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|
| SIS student ID      | external_identity_id    | Student private | Tokenize/normalize if needed | Registrar         | Contract-defined     | Match active record   |
| Catalog course code | course.code             | Internal/public | Normalize subject/number     | Registrar         | Institutional        | Exists and unique     |
| Course section time | section.meeting_pattern | Internal        | Parse time zone/location     | Registrar         | Term lifecycle       | No invalid overlaps   |
| Requirement rule    | requirement.rule        | Internal        | Map to rule schema           | Curriculum office | Curriculum lifecycle | Rule test suite       |
| Student plan item   | plan_item               | Student private | Preserve owner/version       | Student           | Student retention    | Count and owner match |

### 5.5 Parallel run

Use parallel run for any future authoritative replacement.

Legacy system remains official  
 Semester imports/synchronizes approved data  
 Semester performs workflow in shadow mode

Differences are reconciled  
Institution validates results  
Cutover is approved by authorized owners  
Semester becomes authoritative only for approved domain  
Legacy data is archived/exported according to policy

## 5.6 Migration guardrails

Never overwrite student-owned notes, drafts, plans, or consent choices with imported  
Never silently convert estimated data into institution-verified data.  
Never import restricted data into AI context by default.  
Never use production student records in development or test environments unless formally  
Never cut over without rollback, reconciliation, ownership, and support plans.

## 6. First pilot contract outline

# Semester Registration and Path Pilot Agreement

### 6.1 Parties and purpose

Semester [legal entity] (“Semester”)  
Institution [full legal entity] (“Institution”)

Purpose:

A limited, time-bound pilot to provide eligible students with planning, registration-readiness, advisor-agenda, and related student-success workflows.

### 6.2 Pilot scope

Cohort: [25-100] students  
Pilot term: [term/year]  
Pilot duration: [12-26 weeks]  
Use case: Registration readiness and academic pathway planning  
Authorized modules: Today, My Path, Plan, Action Center, advisor agenda, feedback/sup  
Optional scope: SS0; approved catalog/program data; selected calendar connection

### 6.3 Explicit exclusions

Official registration execution  
Official degree certification or graduation decision  
Automatic add/drop/withdrawal  
Production SIS write access  
Official gradebook replacement  
Payment or financial-aid processing  
Housing, dining, health, emergency, or broad parent/supporter portals  
Unrestricted AI agents

Public student social features  
Individual student surveillance or risk scoring

## 6.4 Institution responsibilities

Name executive sponsor, technical owner, privacy/security contact, content owner, and  
Provide cohort invitation and approved pilot communications.  
Provide only the agreed data fields and sources.  
Approve content, program/requirement data, and official links.  
Participate in implementation, training, feedback, and success review.  
Maintain authority for official academic and administrative records.

## 6.5 Semester responsibilities

Provide configured Semester tenant and agreed modules.  
Maintain reasonable technical, administrative, and organizational safeguards.  
Provide onboarding, support, training, and implementation materials.  
Maintain source labels and agreed data boundaries.  
Provide aggregate pilot reporting subject to privacy safeguards.  
Provide incident and support contact path.  
Export or delete pilot data according to the agreement and applicable retention obligations.

## 6.6 Data protection schedule

Include a DPA or data-protection schedule specifying:

Data categories  
Data-subject categories  
Purpose limitation  
Processing duration  
Authorized instructions  
Subprocessors  
Security measures  
Access controls  
Incident notification  
Confidentiality  
Retention/deletion  
Export support  
No unauthorized redisclosure  
No sale of student data  
No behavioral advertising based on education records  
No public-model training on institutional/student data without written authorization

6.7 FERPA and institutional control

Institution determines whether Semester is performing an institutional service/function under the institution’s direct control and for a legitimate educational interest. Semester uses education-record data only for documented, authorized purposes. Semester does not redisclose education-record data except as authorized in writing or Semester supports institution-directed access, correction, export, retention, and deletion.

6.8 Security and incident notification

Security measures are described in an attached security schedule. Semester maintains incident response procedures. Semester notifies Institution of a confirmed security incident involving covered data. Parties coordinate investigation, containment, notification, and remediation.

6.9 Support and service levels

| Service level                  | Suggested pilot commitment                                                |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Support hours                  | Business hours, local institution time zone, unless separately contracted |
| Critical issue acknowledgement | Target within 4 business hours or negotiated window                       |
| High issue acknowledgement     | Target within 1 business day                                              |
| Standard issue acknowledgement | Target within 2 business days                                             |
| Planned maintenance            | Advance notice where practical                                            |
| Status communication           | Public or customer status page / named contact                            |
| Availability                   | State target only after it is measured and operationally supportable      |

Do not promise 24/7 or a specific uptime percentage until the monitoring, on-call, staffing, and contract structure can support it.

6.10 Fees and commercial terms

Implementation fee: [amount]  
Pilot subscription fee: [amount]  
Optional SSO/integration fee: [amount]  
Optional training/support fee: [amount]  
Payment schedule: [e.g., 50% at signature, 50% at launch]  
Expansion credit: [portion of pilot fee credited toward annual subscription if conversion]  
Expenses: [define pre-approved reimbursable expenses if any]

6.11 Success review

- Success measures may include:
- account creation and onboarding
  - Path Snapshot rate
  - plan creation
  - backup-course rate
  - conflict resolution
  - advisor agenda rate
  - search-to-action success
  - student clarity score
  - advisor usefulness score
  - support/friction themes

The parties conduct a review at [date].  
The review informs expansion, renewal, modification, or conclusion of the pilot.  
The agreement must not promise grades, retention, graduation, persistence, or employment

6.12 Termination, exit, and data return

Either party may terminate for material breach subject to cure period.  
Institution may terminate for security, privacy, or legal reasons under defined conditions.  
Semester provides data export in documented format.  
Semester returns/deletes covered data according to contract and retention schedule.  
Semester provides reasonable transition assistance if separately agreed.

6.13 Contract attachments

- A. Pilot Statement of Work
- B. Data Processing Addendum
- C. Security Schedule
- D. Accessibility Statement / VPAT or roadmap
- E. AI Policy and Data-Use Schedule
- F. Support and Escalation Policy
- G. Implementation Plan
- H. Approved Data Field List
- I. Subprocessor Register
- J. Pricing Schedule

7. Higher-ed SaaS SLA and packaging matrix

| Package       | Buyer              | Scope                               | Support          | Integrations          | Commercial model |
|---------------|--------------------|-------------------------------------|------------------|-----------------------|------------------|
| Semester Free | Individual student | Personal planning basics            | Self-service     | Student-selected only | Free             |
| Semester Plus | Individual student | Advanced planning, sharing, exports | Standard support | Calendar/files        | Subscription     |

| Package            | Buyer                  | Scope                                         | Support                              | Integrations                              | Commercial model                 |
|--------------------|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Semester Pro       | Individual student     | Advanced scenarios, career, AI allowance      | Priority self-service                | Expanded personal connections             | Subscription                     |
| Registration Pilot | Department/institution | 25–100 cohort, planning and advisor workflow  | Named implementation/support contact | Optional SSO/catalog read                 | Fixed pilot fee + implementation |
| Department         | College/department     | Configured academic/student-success workflow  | Business-hours support               | SSO, approved source feeds                | Annual license + setup           |
| Campus             | Institution            | Multi-module student experience               | Named customer-success lead          | SSO, LMS/SIS read, content feeds          | Enrollment-band annual license   |
| Enterprise         | System/multi-campus    | Advanced governance, integrations, operations | Premium/negotiated support           | SCIM, advanced SIS/LMS, custom connectors | Multi-year agreement             |

## Pricing principles

Price product access separately from high-touch implementation.  
 Price complex integrations separately from standard configuration.  
 Use enrollment bands or active-user bands for institutional subscription pricing.  
 Do not paywall student data export, deletion, or basic access to student-owned plans  
 Include an AI allowance; meter unusually high-cost use only after transparent notice  
 Offer pilot credits toward annual expansion where commercially appropriate.  
 Do not discount away security, accessibility, support, or implementation obligations

## 8. Go-live command center

Create one command-center page for every pilot launch.

Pilot name and cohort  
 Go-live date  
 Executive sponsor  
 Technical owner  
 Student-success owner  
 Security/privacy owner  
 Accessibility owner  
 Content owner  
 Semester implementation owner  
 Current phase  
 Open blockers  
 Data scope approval  
 SSO status  
 Integration status  
 Content readiness

Accessibility review  
Training completion  
Student communication status  
Support readiness  
Monitoring status  
Rollback readiness  
Success-metric baseline  
Launch decision

## Go/no-go meeting agenda

1. Confirm pilot scope and exclusions.
2. Confirm approved data fields and retention schedule.
3. Confirm access/role/tenant isolation tests.
4. Confirm source freshness and official fallback behavior.
5. Confirm student, advisor, and admin critical journeys.
6. Confirm accessibility test outcomes and known limitations.
7. Confirm support, incident, and escalation contacts.
8. Confirm monitoring, backup, restore, feature flag, and rollback readiness.
9. Confirm launch communications and training.
10. Record go/no-go decision, approvers, risks, and next review date.

## 9. Definition of done

Semester is ready for an institutional pilot when:

A real student can securely create an account or use approved SSO.  
A real student can understand a transparent Path Snapshot.  
A real student can build and save a term plan.  
A real student can identify and resolve a schedule conflict.  
A real student can save backup course options.  
A real student can prepare an advisor meeting agenda.  
A real student can see one clear next action and understand why it appeared.  
A real student can find help or report an issue.  
The product works on mobile, keyboard, and screen-reader basics.  
Data is persistent, tenant-aware, authorized, exportable, and deletable.  
Demo data is visibly labeled and never presented as verified institutional data.  
The team can measure activation, meaningful actions, clarity, advisor usefulness, and  
Monitoring, backup, restore, error tracking, feature flags, rollback, and support con  
The institution has approved the pilot scope, data boundaries, implementation plan, and

## 10. Immediate next actions

1. Convert the HECVAT checklist into an owner-based tracker with evidence links and due dates.
2. Complete the RLS and SECURITY DEFINER remediation register before broader institutional data processing.

3. Build the Migration Center artifacts for the first pilot—even if the pilot uses only curated/manual data.
4. Have counsel convert the pilot contract outline into a Master Subscription Agreement, Pilot SOW, and DPA.
5. Complete the Registration and LMS go-live checklists with actual test evidence, not planned status.
6. Run an accessibility review of the core student path, term plan, advisor agenda, and support flow.
7. Run an incident-response and backup-restore tabletop before go-live.
8. Prepare the institutional Trust Room and HECVAT response library.
9. Select one cohort, one sponsor, one workflow, and one date for the first launch.
10. Conduct the formal go/no-go meeting and document the decision.